A pioneering chemist and freedom fighter, **Dr Khwaja Abdul Hamied** was born in Aligarh. After some years spent studying in Germany, he returned to India and founded the Chemical, Industrial and Pharmaceutical Laboratories (CIPLA) in 1935. At the time, India was heavily dependent on foreign manufacturers for drugs. Hamied hoped, through the research and development of drugs, to help India become self-sufficient. He was also part of the Bombay Legislative Council and later appointed the sheriff of Bombay. Currently run by his son Yusuf, CIPLA manufactures high quality, affordable drugs, which have helped save lives all over the world.